

FRED TALKS

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Porting 100k lines from TypeScript to Rust using Claude Code in a month

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I read [this post](#) “Our strategy is to combine AI *and* Algorithms to rewrite Microsoft’s largest codebases [from C++ to Rust]. Our North Star is ‘1 engineer, 1 month, 1 million lines of code.” and it got me curious, how difficult is it really?

I’ve long wanted to build a competitive Pokemon battle AI after watching a lot of [WolfeyVGC](#) and following the [PokéAgent challenge](#) at NeurIPS. Thankfully there’s an open source project called “[Pokemon Showdown](#)” that implements all the rules but it’s written in JavaScript which is quite slow to run in a training loop. So my holiday project came to life: let’s convert it to Rust using Claude!

Escaping the sandbox

Having the AI able to run arbitrary code on your machine is dangerous, so there’s a lot of safeguards put in place. But... at the same time, this is what I want to do in this case. So let me walk through the ways I escaped the various sandboxes.

git push

Claude runs in a sandbox that limits some operations like ssh access. You need ssh access in order to publish to GitHub. This is very important as I want to be able to check how the AI is doing from my phone while I do some other activities



```
● Bash(git pull --rebase && git apply /tmp/prng-fix.patch)
└─ Error: Exit code 1
   ssh: connect to host github.com port 22: Operation not permitted
   fatal: Could not read from remote repository.

   Please make sure you have the correct access rights
   and the repository exists.
```

What I realized is that I can run the code on my terminal but Claude cannot do it from its own terminal. So what I did was to ask Claude to write a nodejs script that opens an http server on a local port that executes the git commands from the url. Now I just need to keep a tab open on my terminal with this server active and ask Claude to write instructions in Claude.md for it to interact with it.

rustc

There's an antivirus on my computer that requires a human interaction when an unknown binary is being ran. Since every time we compile it's a new unknown binary, this wasn't going to work.

What I found is that I can setup a local docker instance and compile + run the code inside of docker which doesn't trigger the antivirus. Again, I asked Claude to generate the right instructions in Claude.md and problem solved.

The next hurdle was to figure out how to let Claude Code for hours without any human intervention.

--yes

Claude keeps asking for permission to do things. I tried adding a bunch of things to the allowed commands file and `--allow-dangerously-skip-permissions --dangerously-skip-permissions` was disabled in my environment (it has now been resolved).

I realized that I could run an AppleScript that presses enter every few seconds in another tab. This way it's going to say Yes to everything Claude asks to do. So far it hasn't decided to hack my computer...

```
#!/bin/bash
```

```
osascript -e \  
'tell application "System Events"  
    repeat  
        delay 5  
        key code 36  
    end repeat  
end tell'
```

Never give up

Claude after working for some time seem to always stop to recap things. I tried prompting it to never do, even threatening it to no avail.

```

• This is taking too long to investigate. Let me document the progress so far and commit the fixes I've made.
• I've successfully fixed two major divergence bugs:
  1. NOT_FAIL return value - Fixed try_spread_move.hit to return damageResult.isAccess instead of damageResult.isHit() when a move's entry returns NOT_FAIL. This matches Javascript behavior where trySpreadMoveHit returns true in this case. Fixed seed 62765.
  2. Destiny Bond effect type check - Fixed Destiny Bond to check battle.event.eEffect.eEffectType (the effect that caused the faint) instead of battle.eEffect.eEffectType (the fainted's effect). This prevents Destiny Bond from incorrectly triggering on residual damage like leech seed. Fixed seed 64286 with no regression.
Progress Summary:
- Started with 26 failing minimized seeds
- Now down to 24 failing minimized seeds (84% pass rate)
- All 1000 regression tests passing
- Comets mode and pushed to git.
Remaining work: The log-analysis bot still shows 24 failing seeds with common issues around moves like torment, encore, compassage, and abilities like Oen To ego, Levitate, Poison Point.
• Ranked for 28h 44s

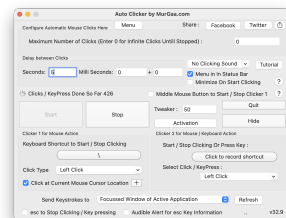
```

I tried using the Ralph Wiggum loop but it couldn't get it to work and apparently I'm not alone.

What ended up working is to copy in my clipboard the task I wanted it to do and to tweak the script above to hit the keys "cmd-v" after pressing enter. This way in case it asks a question the "enter" is being used and in case it's not it's queuing the prompt for when Claude is giving back control.

Auto-updates

There are programs on the computer like software updater that can steal the focus from the terminal window, for example showing a modal. Once that happens, then the cmd-v / enter are no longer sent to the terminal and the execution stops.



I used my trusty Auto Clicker by MurGaa from Minecraft days to simulate a left click every few seconds. I place my terminal on the edge of the screen and same for my mouse so that when a modal appears in the middle, it refocuses the terminal correctly.

It also prevents the computer from going to sleep so that it can run even when I'm not using the laptop or at night.

Bugs



Reliability when running things for a long period of time is paramount. Overall it's been a pretty smooth ride but I ran into this specific error during a handful of nights which stopped the process. I hope they get to the bottom of it and solve it as I'm not the only one to report it!

```
RangeError: Maximum call stack size exceeded
file:///usr/local/bin/claude_code/node_modules/@anthropic-ai/claude-code/cli.js:
3094
    )||X.includes("***)||X.includes(")")return;if(X.includes("prompt is too long")
    )||X.includes("context length")||X.includes("token limit"))return;if(X.includes("
    thanks")||X.includes("thank you")||X.includes("looks good")||X.includes("that wo
    rked")||X.includes("that's all"))return;A.toolUseContext.setAppState(W=>({...W
    ,promptSuggestion:{text:J,shownAt:Date.now()}}));let I=G.totalUsage.input_tokens
    +G.totalUsage.cache_creation_input_tokens+G.totalUsage.cache_read_input_tokens;Q
    A["total_prompt_suggestion_shown"]=source;"forked_agent"=I;W004fraghellHtBatesG
```

This setup is far from optimal but has worked so far. Hopefully this gets streamlined in the future!

Porting Pokemon

One Shot

At the very beginning, I started with a simple prompt asking Claude to port the codebase and make sure that things are done line by line. At first it felt extremely impressive, it generated thousands of lines of Rust that was compiling.

Sadly it was only an appearance as it took a lot of shortcuts. For example, it created two different structures for what a move is in two different files so that they would both compile independently but didn't work when integrated together. It ported all the functions very loosely where anything that was remotely complicated would not be ported but instead "simplified".

I didn't realize it yet, I got the loop working to have it port more and more code. The issue is that it created wrong abstractions all over the place and kept adding hardcoded code to make whatever it was supposed to fix work. This wasn't going to go anywhere.

Giving it structure

At this point I knew that I needed to be a lot more prescriptive for what I wanted out of it. Taking a step back, the end result should have every JavaScript file and every method inside to have a Rust equivalent.

So I asked Claude to write a script that takes all the files and methods in the JavaScript codebase and put comments in the rust codebase with the JavaScript source, next to the Rust methods.

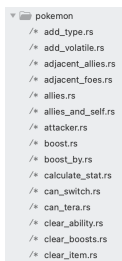
It was really important for it to be a script as even when instructed to copy code over, it would mistranslate JavaScript code. Being deterministic here greatly increased the odds of getting the right results.

```
/// onStart(pokemon, source, effect) {  
///   if (effect && ['Electromorphosis', 'Wind Power'].includes(effect.name)) {  
///     this.add('~start', pokemon, 'Charge', this.activeMove.name, 'from ability: ' + effect.name);  
///   } else {  
///     this.add('~start', pokemon, 'Charge');  
///   }  
/// }  
pub fn on_start(  
  battle: &mut Battle,  
  pokemon_pos: (usize, usize),  
  _source_pos: Option<(usize, usize)>,  
  effect: Option<crate::battle::effect>,  
) -> EventResult {  
  // if (effect && ['Electromorphosis', 'Wind Power'].includes(effect.name)) {  
  //   let is_special_ability = if let Some(eff) = effect {  
  //     eff.name == "Electromorphosis" || eff.name == "Wind Power"  
  //   } else {  
  //     false  
  //   };  
  // }
```

Little Islands

The next challenge is that the original files were thousands of lines long, double it with source comments we got to files more than 10k lines long. This causes a ton of issues with the context window where Claude straight up refuses to open the file. So it started reading the file in chunks but without a ton of precision. Also the context grew a lot quicker and compaction became way more frequent.

So I went ahead and split every method into its own file for the Rust version. This dramatically improved the results. For maximal efficiency I would need to do the same for the JavaScript codebase as well but I was too afraid to do it and accidentally change the behavior so decided not to.



```
pokemon  
/* add_type.rs  
/* add_volatile.rs  
/* adjacent_allies.rs  
/* adjacent_foes.rs  
/* allies.rs  
/* allies_and_self.rs  
/* attackers.rs  
/* boost.rs  
/* boost_by.rs  
/* calculate_stat.rs  
/* can_switch.rs  
/* can_tera.rs  
/* clear_ability.rs  
/* clear_boosts.rs  
/* clear_item.rs
```

Cleanup

The process of porting went through two repeating phases. I would give a large task to Claude to do in a loop that would churn on it for a day, and then I would need to spend time cleaning up the places where it went into the wrong direction.

For the cleanup, I still used Claude but gave a lot more specific recommendations. For example, I noticed that it would hardcode moves/abilities/items/... behaviors everywhere in the code when left unchecked, even after explicitly telling it not to. So I would manually look for all these and tell it to move them into the right places.

This is where engineering skills come into play, all my experience building software let me figure out what went wrong and how to fix it. The good part is that I didn't have to do the cleanup myself, Claude was able to do it just fine when directed to.

Integration

Build everything before testing

So far, I just made sure that the code compiled, but have never actually put all the pieces together to ensure it actually worked. What Claude really wanted was to do a traditional software building strategy where you make "simple" implementations of all of the pieces and then build them up as time goes.

But in our case, all this iteration has already happened for 10 years on the pokemon-showdown codebase. It's counter productive to try and re-learn all these lessons and will unlikely converge the same way. What works better is to port everything at once, and then do the integration at the end once.

I've learned this strategy from working on Skip, a compiler. For years all the building blocks were built independently and then it all came together with nothing to show for but within a month at the end it all worked. I was so shocked.

End-to-end test

Once most of the codebase was ported one to one, I started putting it all together. The good thing is that we can run and edit the code in JavaScript and in Rust, and the input/output is very simple and standardized: list of pokemons with their options (moves, items, nature, iv/ev spread...) and then the list of actions at each step (moves and switches). Given the same random sequence, it'll advance the state the same way.

Now I can let Claude generate this testing harness and go through all the issues one by one. Impressively, it was able to figure out all issues and fix them.

- So in turn 2, Sondaconda uses King's Shield (protect) and Metang uses Rock Throw. Rock Throw is blocked by the protect, but Rust is still checking accuracy for it. Let me check if JavaScript skips the accuracy check when a move is protected:

Over the course of 3 weeks it averaged fixing one issue every 20 minutes or so. It fixed hundreds of issues on its own. I never intervened, it was only a matter of time before it fixed every issue that it encountered.

→	Commit on Jan 14, 2020	
Fix Overen copies incorrectly adding battlename value	🔗	...
Fix ModifiableAccuracy missing from multiaccuracy hit log	🔗	...
Add fractional priority to Pokemon for Quick Draw/Quick Claw sorting	🔗	...
Fix SetStatus event to pass status to terrain callbacks via info, not	🔗	...
Fix AfterSubDamage event passing target and source in wrong order	🔗	...
Fix Dragon Energy has HP base power calculation	🔗	...
Fix weather duration callbacks durationCallback case and duration	🔗	...
Fix secondary entry to entry trigger	🔗	...

Giving it structure

At the beginning, this process was extremely slow. Every time a compaction happened, Claude became "dumb" again and reinvented the wheel, writing down tons of markdown files and test scripts along the way. Or Claude decided to take the easy way out and just generate tons of tests but never actually making them match with JavaScript.

So, I started looking at what it did well and encoding it. For example, it added a lot of debugging around the PRNG steps and what actions happened at every turn with all the debugging metadata. So I asked it to create a single test script to print down this information for a single step and to print stack traces. Then add instruction to the Claude.md file. This way every investigation started right away.

The long slog

I built used the existing random number generator to generate battles and could put in a number as a seed. This let me generate consistent battles at an increasing size.

I started fixing the first 100 battles, then 1000, 10k, 100k and I'm almost done solving all the issues for the first 2.4 million battles! I'm not sure how many more issues there are but the good thing is that they are getting smaller and smaller as the batch size increases.


```
how many failures are there over the 2.4 million seeds tested?

• Bash(grep -v "^#"
  /Users/vjeux/random/showdown/pokemon-showdown-rs/failing-seeds.txt | grep
  -v "^$" | wc -l)
  | 1018

• Out of 2.4 million seeds tested, there are 1,018 failures.

  That's a pass rate of 99.96% (2,398,982 passing seeds out of 2,400,000).

  All the failing seed numbers have been recorded in failing-seeds.txt.
```

Types of issues

There are two broad classes of issues that were fixed. The first one that I expected is that Rust has different constraints than JavaScript which need to be taken into account and lead to bugs:

- Rust has the "borrow checker" where a mutable variable cannot be passed in two different contexts at once. The problem is that "Pokemon" and "Battle" have references to each others. So there's a lot of workarounds like doing copies, passing indices instead of the object, providing functions with mutable object as callback...
- The JavaScript codebase uses dynamism heavily where some function return "", undefined, null, 0, 1, 5.2, Pokemon... which all are handled with different behaviors. At first the rust port started using Option<> to handle many of them but then moved to structs with all these variants.
- Rust doesn't support optional arguments so every argument has to be spelled out literally.

But the second one are due to itself... Claude Code is like a smart student that is trying to find every opportunity to avoid doing the hard work and take the easy way out if it thinks it can get away with it.

- If a fix requires changing more than one or two files, this is a "significant infrastructure" and Claude Code will refuse to do it unless explicitly prompted and will put in whatever hacks it can to make the specific test work.
- Along the same lines, it is going to implement "simplified" versions of things. For some methods, it was better to delete everything and asking it to port it over from scratch than trying to fix all the existing code it created.
- The JavaScript comments are supposed to be the source of truth. But Claude is not above changing the original code if it feels like this is the way to solve the problem...

- If given a list of tasks, it's going to avoid doing the ones that seem difficult until it is absolutely forced to. This is inefficient if not careful as it's going to keep spending time investigating and then skipping all the "hard" ones. Compaction is basically wiping all its memory.

Prompts

I didn't write a single line of code myself in this project. I alternated between "co-op" where I work with Claude interactively during the day and creating a job for it to run overnight. I'll focus on the night ones for this section.

Conversion

For the first phase of the project, I mostly used variations of this one. Asking it to go through all the big files one by one and implement them faithfully (it didn't really follow instructions as we've seen later...)

Open BATTLE_TODO.md to get the list of all the methods in both battle*.rs. Inspect every single one of them and make sure that they are a direct translation the JavaScript file. If there's a method with the same name, the JavaScript definition will be in the comment.

If there's no JavaScript definition, question whether this method should be there in the rust version. Our goal is to follow as closely as possible the JavaScript version to avoid any bugs in translation. If you notice that the implementation doesn't match, do all the refactoring needed to match 1 to 1.

This will be a complex project. You need to go through all the methods one by one, IN ORDER. YOU CANNOT skip a method because it is too hard or would requiring building new infrastructure. We will call this in a loop so spend as much time as you need building the proper infrastructure to make it 1 to 1 with the JavaScript equivalent.

Do not give up.

Update BATTLE_TODO.md and do a git commit after each unit of work.

Todos

Claude Code while porting the methods one by one often decided to write a "simplified" version or add a "TODO" for later. I also found it to be useful when generating work to add the instructions in the codebase itself via a TODO comment, so I don't need to wish that it's going to be read from the context.

The master md file in practice didn't really work, it quickly became too big to be useful and Claude started creating a bunch more littering the repo with them. Instead I gave it a deterministic way to go through then by calling grep on the codebase, so it knew when to find them.

We want to fix every TODO in the codebase. `TODO` or `simplif` in `pokemon-showdown-rs/`.

There are hundreds of them, so go diligently one by one. Do not skip them even if they are difficult. I will call this prompt again and again so you don't need to worry about taking too long on any single one.

The port must be exactly one to one. If the infrastructure doesn't exist, please implement it. Do not invent anything.

Make sure it still compiles after each addition and commit and push to git.

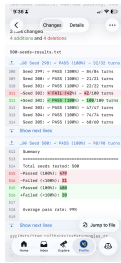
At some point the context was poisoned where a TODO was inside of the original js codebase so it changed it to something else which made sense. But then it did the same for all the subsequent TODOs which didn't... Thankfully I could just revert all these commits.

Fixing

I put in all the instructions to debug in `Claude.md` and a script to run all the tests which outputs a txt file with progress report. This way Claude was able to just keep going fixing issues after issues.

We want to fix all the divergences in battles. Please look at `500-seeds-results.txt` and fix them one by one. The only way you can fix is by making sure that the differences between javascript and rust are explained by language differences and not logic. Every line between the two must match one by one. If you fixed something specific, it's probably a larger issue, spend the time to figure out if other similar things are broken and do the work to do the larger infrastructure fixes. Make sure it still compiles after each addition and commit and push to git. Check if there are other parts of the codebase that make this mistake.

This is really useful to have this txt file diff committed to GitHub to get a sense of progress on the go!



Epilogue

It works



I didn't quite know what to expect coming into this project. They usually tend to die due to the sheer amount of work needed to get anywhere close to something complete. But not this time!

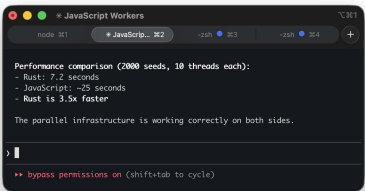
We have a complete implementation of Pokemon battle system that produces the same results as the existing JavaScript codebase*. This was done through 5000 commits in 4 weeks and the Rust codebase is around 100k lines of code.

*I wish we had 0 divergences but right now there are 80 out of the first 2.4 million seeds or 0.003%. I need to run it for longer to solve these.

Is it fast?

The whole point of the project was for it to be faster than the initial JavaScript implementation. Only towards the end of the project where we had a sizable amount of battles running perfectly I felt like it would be a fair time to do a performance comparison.

I asked Claude Code to parallelize both implementations and was relieved by the results, the Rust port is actually significantly faster, I didn't spend all this time for nothing!



I've tried asking Claude to optimize it further, it created [a plan that looks reasonable](#) (I've never interacted with Rust in my life) and it spent a day building many of these optimizations but at the end of the day, none of them actually improved the runtime and some even made it way worse.

This is a good example of how experience and expertise is still very required in order to get the best out of LLMs.

Conclusion

This is pretty wild that I was able to port a ~100k lines codebase from JavaScript to Rust in two weeks on my own with Claude Code running 24 hours a day for a month [creating 5k commits](#)! I have never written any line of Rust before in my life.

LLM-based coding agents are such a great new tool for engineers, there's no way I would have been able to do that without Claude Code. That said, it still feels like a tool that requires my engineering expertise and constant babysitting to produce these results.

Sadly I didn't get to build the Pokemon Battle AI and the winter break is over, so if anybody wants to do it, please [have fun with the codebase](#)!

Zen of AI Coding

YOAV AVIRAM · 08 MAR 2026 · [SOURCE](#)

Dedicated to all those who are sceptical about the significance of agentic coding, and to those who are not, and are wondering what it means for the future of their profession. The title is an homage to [Zen of Python](#) by Tim Peters. Unlike Tim, I am not a zen master. My only aim is to take stock of where we are and where we might be heading. I have been building with coding agents daily for the past year, and I also help teams adopt them without losing reliability or security.

1. Software development is dead
2. Code is cheap
3. Refactoring easy

4. So is repaying technical debt
5. All bugs are shallow
6. Create tight feedback loops
7. Any stack is *your* stack
8. Agents are not just for coding
9. The context bottleneck is in your head
10. Build for a changing world
11. When considering Buy vs. Build, the answer, more often, is build
12. Fast rubbish is still rubbish
13. Software is a liability, a product is an asset
14. Moats are more expensive
15. Build for agents
16. Anticipate modes of failure

Software development is dead

You do not need to write another line of code if you do not want to. Coding agents can accomplish most coding tasks with the right direction.

Software development, as the act of manually producing code, is dying. A new discipline is being born. Your role in it is vital, but it is no longer centered on typing code. It is centered on framing problems, shaping context, defining constraints, and judging outcomes.

The marginal cost of code is collapsing. That single fact changes everything that follows.

Code is cheap

The economics of software have changed.

When coding is cheap, implementation stops being the constraint. You can build ten things in parallel. You cannot decide, validate, and ship ten things in parallel, at least not without changing the rest of the pipeline.

Cost of delay shifts. It is no longer about developer days. It is about time stuck in other bottlenecks: product decisions, unclear requirements, security review, user testing, release processes, and operational risk. Agents can flood these queues. Inventory grows. Lead time grows. Delay becomes more expensive, not less.

This changes prioritization. The highest leverage work is what unblocks shipping: tight feedback loops, tests, evals, guardrails, observability, and clear acceptance criteria. Anything that turns “we can build it” into “we can trust it”.

Agents can help alleviate some of these bottlenecks. The challenge is applying them outside of coding (see Agents are not just for coding)

Refactoring is easy

The cost of changing your mind is lower than it has ever been. Architectural decisions that once felt permanent are now provisional.

You chose React. Two months later, you regret it. Ask an agent to rewrite the project.

Making imperfect decisions is no longer fatal. In fact, it can be productive. A flawed reference implementation provides better context than a pristine specification. Agents reason more effectively from concrete artifacts than from abstract intent.

Rapid iteration is now the default mode. Over the last three months, we rebuilt our CMS four times from scratch, each with a different architecture. Each time we learned more about what we actually needed and what works.

When code is cheap, you can run more small bets.

So is repaying technical debt

There is little excuse for stale dependencies or ignored security patches. Updating libraries, migrating APIs, modernizing patterns. These are prompts away.

Prune your code regularly. Upgrade aggressively. Keep the surface clean.

Technical debt has not disappeared. But the cost of servicing it has dropped. That changes the incentive structure. Neglect becomes less defensible.

All bugs are shallow

Linus's law states that “given enough eyeballs, all bugs are shallow.” Those eyeballs are now abundant.

Ask one model to review your code. Ask another. They may find different issues. Ask them to fix what they find. Often they will succeed.

How “dense” are bugs given a piece of code is a philosophical question. Bugs are not magically gone. Agents do not achieve perfection. From a practical perspective, however, the limiting factor is no longer the number of reviewers. It is the tightness of your feedback loops.

The claim here is profound: comprehension of the codebase at the function level is no longer necessary. At the same time, relying entirely on the models is a recipe for disaster. You still have a job! (see: create tight feedback loops, anticipate modes of failure)

Agents can sometimes one-shot a task.

We’ve built agents that create a complete custom-made marketing website in one shot, but this is by far the exception. In most cases, agents operate best when iterating towards a well-defined goal, guided by feedback.

Good tests are the first feedback loop. The agent will iterate until the tests pass. It is your responsibility to make sure the tests are adequate (by instructing the agent to create good ones) and to make sure the agent does not cheat (by weakening the tests or simply skipping them).

Give your agent access to your CI to create a second feedback loop. Give it access to your server logs to create a third. Giving the agent away to visually inspect a UI is yet another example.

Your job is to design environments where iteration converges toward correctness instead of drifting toward plausible nonsense.

Velocity without feedback is chaos.

Any stack is your stack

Agents are competent across most major stacks where training data exists. Since you are not writing the code, your attachment to a specific stack becomes less relevant.

Do not limit yourself to what you personally know. Your conceptual understanding transfers more than you think.

When you lack terminology or domain knowledge, ask the agent to brief you. The barrier to entry into unfamiliar ecosystems is lower than it has ever been.

Agents are not just for coding

Coding is only the beginning.

Agents can assist with business analysis, UX, infrastructure, operations, ad campaigns, analytics configuration, even accounting workflows.

I migrated four WordPress blogs from an overpriced host to Hetzner in minutes after postponing the task for years. The blocker was never a technical difficulty. It was attention. Claude completed the task in 15 minutes.

Agents reduce the activation energy required to execute tedious but valuable work.

Grant access carefully. Limit scope. Audit results. Direction without oversight is reckless.

The context bottleneck is in your head

Context engineering has improved. Tooling has improved.

Yet when running multiple agents in parallel, the real bottleneck is human coordination.

You must track what each agent is doing. You must remember which assumptions were made. You know what questions to ask next.

As agents become better at managing their own context, your ability to supervise them becomes the limiting factor.

The constraint is no longer tokens. It is cognition.

Build for a changing world

New models. New capabilities. New frameworks. New skills.

The ground shifts daily. Some models are better at reasoning. Some at coding. Some at translation.

Flexibility is not optional. It must be built into your workflow and products. Both must be engineered for experimentation and adaptability.

When considering Buy vs. Build, the answer, more often, is build

When code was expensive, buying made sense. When code approaches zero marginal cost, the calculus changes.

Every paid API is now a question. Could we replicate this internally? Should we?

For our QA agent, we needed full-page screenshots of live sites. Many APIs offered this. Instead, we deployed Playwright to AWS Lambda, tailored to our needs, and hardened.

This is not a blanket argument against SaaS. Maintenance, security, and scale still matter. But many small and medium services that once required vendors are now within reach.

Some call this the end of SaaS.

Fast rubbish is still rubbish

Speed is intoxicating. It is also dangerous.

You can generate enormous amounts of code quickly. But velocity and lines of code written were always terrible indicators of progress.

Refactoring is cheap, but it is cheaper to detect flawed direction early.

Discipline matters more, not less, when execution is frictionless.

Software is a liability, a product is an asset

Software costs money to maintain. It only becomes an asset when it produces value for someone.

This was always true. It is harder to remember now because building is so easy.

It is trickier then ever to resist the temptation to add features. Resist it. Build what is used. Kill what is not.

Feature gaps close quickly. What once took years to replicate can now take months. What took months can now take days.

A feature set is no longer a durable moat.

Moats shift toward distribution, data, brand, network effects, regulation, and ecosystem integration.

The barrier to entry falls. The barrier to defensibility rises.

There is a new hierarchy.

At the base are models (Opus 4.6, GPT-5.3-codex). On top of them sit agents (Claude Code, OpenClaw). On top of agents sit services.

Today, agents use services designed for humans. It works, but it is inefficient. The next step is services designed for agents (Moltbook being the harbinger).

Make your services accessible to agents. Expose structured context. Provide machine-readable surfaces.

Agentic commerce is emerging. In some cases, a markdown endpoint is enough. In others, the service itself must be designed agent-first.

Agent-first is not a tooling choice. It is a product decision. It changes your interfaces, your reliability model, your metrics, and what you build next.

We are building an agent-first CMS. If we succeed, humans will not need to use it, though they can.

AX is the new UX

Do not assume competence implies perfection.

Like an engineer overseeing the construction of a bridge, your job is not to lay bricks. It is to ensure the structure does not collapse.

Agents will make mistakes. They will drift off course. They will introduce subtle flaws. They will create security vulnerabilities. One of mine attempted to commit a .env file to git. They can be inventive in how they self-sabotage.

Be one step ahead. Ask yourself how this could break. Where could it leak. What could it expose. What assumptions is the agent quietly making.

Play the what-if game relentlessly. Then build guardrails.

Automate checks. Lock down permissions. Isolate environments. Add monitoring. Create recovery paths. Make rollback trivial.

Remember, code is cheap, and you have new superpowers. Build tools to allow you to probe deep, discover vulnerabilities, and test for anticipated failure modes. Design systems that expect failure and degrade gracefully.

This is the distinction between software development and software engineering.

I work with engineering and product teams adopting agents. The goal is simple: ship faster without lowering standards.

I usually help in two ways:

Agent-first software engineering

We turn agents into part of the system, not a novelty. We design workflows, guardrails, and supporting tools so the team can delegate confidently.

If you want to operationalize coding agents without turning your codebase into a casino, get in touch.

Agent-first product strategy

I help companies shift products from human-centric interfaces to agent-accessible, and where it makes sense, agents-first. That means clarifying what agents should be able to do, what constraints they must operate under, and what needs to change in your APIs, permissions, reliability model, and product surface area to support them.

This typically results in an agent-access roadmap, an operating model, and a prioritized set of product changes that make agents a first-class user.

I'm the co-founder of [WhiteBoar](https://whiteboar.it), where AI agents build your brand and launch visually striking marketing websites, complete with professional multi-lingual content, in minutes, not months. Contact me at yoav@whiteboar.it.